

Date Chain *Autopsy.*

A 10-slide decomposition of how Maestro
propagates a single date through the supply graph
— and the one branch *it never imports*.

DemandDate



DueDate



DockDate



ShipDate



BuiltdDate



StartDate

- SafetyLT

- DockToStock

- TransitTime

- PreShipLT

- FixedLT / VarLT

AvailableDate = CTP t

Seven links, one hidden branch.

Six are imported. One is not.

Maestro stores eight dates per supply order. Five are produced by a top-down subtraction chain that begins at **DemandDate** and ends at **StartDate**. The eighth — **AvailableDate** — is the only date Maestro *always* calculates and never imports, propagated bottom-up by CTP through the BOM. Confusing the two directions is the single most common cause of a date-chain ticket.



TOP-
DOWN

5 subtractions, 6 nodes, all imported from
ScheduledReceipt when LT0=Yes.

BOTTOM-
UP

AvailableDate derives from CTP propagation through
BOM components — never read from the order.

01/02

DEMANDDATE
DUEDATE
DOCKDATE
SHIPDATE
BUILDDATE
STARTDATE

The first cut *is the safety lead time.*

Maestro starts at the demand horizon and walks backwards. The first subtraction is the safety lead time — a buffer that pulls the receipt date earlier than the customer needs the part.

DueDate

=

DemandDate

-

SafetyLT

DemandDate	When the customer needs goods on the floor — the chain anchor.	IMPORTED
SafetyLT	Calendar-day buffer pulled from PartSource or Part.	IMPORTED
DueDate	When the order must be receipted in stores — the first internal date.	COMPUTED

FIELD-TESTED GOTCHA

When LT0 = Yes, every link below DueDate is read from ScheduledReceipt wholesale. You cannot override only one segment — it is all or nothing.

The dock-to-stock interlude — *where transit hides.*

Two short subtractions sit between the warehouse acceptance date and the moment the carrier leaves the source plant. They look identical on a Gantt; they cost very different things in real life.

$$03 \quad \text{DockDate} = \text{DueDate} - \text{DockToStock}$$

Inbound put-away buffer — internal time to inspect, label, and shelve. **Quality-managed parts inflate this silently.**

$$04 \quad \text{ShipDate} = \text{DockDate} - \text{TransitTime}$$

Carrier window from supplier dock to your dock. On STO, **this is the field that disappears under LT0=Yes.**

WHY THIS MATTERS

A 14-day **DockToStock** on a make-to-stock API and a 14-day **TransitTime** on its finished good produce identical Gantts. They are not the same buffer. One you can compress with a quality waiver. The other you cannot compress without changing carrier.

Three more subtractions *to the floor.* *Then the chain stops.*

05

PRE-SHIP

$$\text{BuildDate} \cdot \text{ShipDate} - \text{PreShipLT}$$

$$\text{BuildDate} = \text{ShipDate} - \text{PreShipLT}$$

Wash, label, palletize, stage at the outbound dock. Often configured as zero on commodity goods **and as 5–7 days on regulated material** (pharma batch release, hazmat documentation).

06

PRODUCTION

$$\text{StartDate} \cdot \text{BuildDate} - \text{FixedLT} - \text{VarLT}(\text{qty})$$

$$\text{StartDate} = \text{BuildDate} - \text{FixedLT} - \text{VarLT}(\text{qty})$$

The release date for production. **VarLT scales with order quantity** — increasing the lot size pushes **StartDate** earlier, not **BuildDate** later.

07

RELEASE
(STO ONLY)
$$\text{Transfer orders} \cdot \text{demand peg} = \text{BuildDate}$$

$$\text{Source-side demand peg} \rightarrow \text{BuildDate} \quad (\text{not StartDate})$$

One subtle Ch.14 footnote planners miss: a transfer order pegs its source plant on the **BuildDate**, not the **StartDate**. Misreading this turns into ghost shortages on the sending site.

REMINDER The chain ends at **StartDate**. Anything earlier — material availability, capacity windows — is a different question, with a different engine, on the next slide.

Six dates flow *down*. One date flows *up*.

TOP-DOWN · IMPORTED

6 dates

All read from `ScheduledReceipt` when `LTO=Yes`; otherwise re-derived from `PartSource` lead-time fields. The engine only computes them — it does not invent them.

`DemandDate`

`DueDate`

`DockDate`

`ShipDate`

`BuiltDate`

`StartDate`

BOTTOM-UP · NEVER IMPORTED

1 date

`AvailableDate` is the earliest date the order *could* be ready given the availability of every component below it in the BOM. CTP propagates it bottom-up. No SAP record ever sets it. No `.tab` file can carry it.

`AvailableDate`

MENTAL MODEL

*“The top-down chain says *when* this order should arrive.*

*The bottom-up branch says *when it actually can*. Their disagreement is the planner's daily inbox.”*

SOURCE: MAESTRO DATA MODEL & ALGORITHM GUIDE · CH. 14, CH. 19 (CTP)

Three values, *three different machines*.

SupplyStatus.LT0 is rendered as a single column in the planning sheet, but it switches Maestro between three completely different lead-time engines. The names suggest a sliding scale; the behaviours are discrete states.

MODE A No DueDate = Today + FixedLT + DockToStock SOURCEPartSource · all LT fields ENGINERecompute on every plan USEPlanned orders, requisitions, internal MTO Default for forward-planning. Lead times are engineering knobs and the engine respects them.	MODE B · DESTRUCTIVE Yes All dates ← ScheduledReceipt (no recalc) SOURCEScheduledReceipt as imported ENGINENo date recompute, all or nothing USEFirm POs, work orders honoured by SAP Trap on transfers (STO): the engine drops transit time entirely if the source plant is not feeding it.	MODE C FromOrder DueDate = LT field on the order itself SOURCEOrder.LT column ENGINEPer-order override, no master data USEOpenRecommendSTO, supplier-confirmed slots Reserved for STO recommendations where each order carries its own committed lead time from the carrier.
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ONE MORE LEVER IgnoreStartDate=Yes overrides the imported StartDate and forces Maestro to re-derive it from the chain. IgnoreCalcDate=Yes freezes the DueDate against any recompute. They are independent — and they layer.

EXHIBIT A

STO RECOMMENDATION · PLANT 8359 → 8712 · LTO=YES

When LTO=Yes *on a transfer order*, Maestro silently drops your transit time.



SYMPTOM

Planner flags an OpenRecommendSTO with a StartDate matching the requested ship date — no transit window at all.



NAIVE READ

The first hypothesis is always the carrier calendar. It is never the carrier calendar.



WALK THE CHAIN

Top-down chain says ShipDate = DockDate - TransitTime. TransitTime on PartSource is correct. It is not being read.



EVIDENCE

SupplyStatus.LTO = Yes on the recommendation. All eight dates are read from ScheduledReceipt wholesale — and the inbound feed never carried TransitTime.



RULE

You cannot override *one* link of the chain when LTO=Yes. It is all or nothing.

EXHIBIT B · FIELD-BY-FIELD

*The transit time is on PartSource.
Maestro is reading
ScheduledReceipt.*

FIELD	PARTSOURCE	USED BY ENGINE
FixedLT	14 d	— ignored
TransitTime	7 d	— ignored
DockToStock	2 d	— ignored
All dates	—	ScheduledReceipt

RESOLUTION

For STO recommendations: set LTO = FromOrder, set IgnoreStartDate = Ignore, and let the carrier window from the order itself populate the chain. For confirmed open POs / WOs / WO allocations, LTO = Yes remains correct — they should honour SAP's dates verbatim.

CalcStartDate is not StartDate.

When Maestro flags an order to reschedule, it does not simply push the chain. It computes a **delta** between the effective due date and the rescheduled due date, then **adds that delta to the existing StartDate**. The order keeps its production-side phasing.

- Only when **StartDate** is already populated.
- Only on rescheduled (not net-new) orders.
- Independent of **LT0**.

RESCHEDULE FORMULA · CH. 14

CalcStartDate

= StartDate

+ (ReschedDate - EffDueDate)

StartDate	The production release date as currently held on the order. Untouched by the recompute.
ReschedDate	The new target date the engine wants to honour. Often equals the recomputed DueDate.
EffDueDate	The effective due date the order was last anchored to. Read from the order, not recomputed.
Δ	The shift, signed. Positive = push later, negative = pull in.

WHY IT'S BUILT THIS WAY

The chain protects production phasing. Recomputing StartDate from a fresh DueDate would erase any manual finite scheduling already applied — the delta keeps it intact.

SOURCE: CH. 14

Six dates down. One date *up*.

SOURCES

Maestro Data Model
& Algorithm Guide

SU2603 • Ch. 14

Maestro Data Model
& Algorithm Guide

SU2603 • Ch. 19 (CTP)

Hypercare casework

2025-2026

- i.* The chain is a top-down subtraction. `AvailableDate` is the only date Maestro never imports.
- ii.* `LT0=Yes` reads *every* date from `ScheduledReceipt`. You cannot override one segment.
- iii.* Transfers peg the source plant on `BuiltDate` — not `StartDate`.
- iv.* On reschedule, $\text{CalcStartDate} = \text{StartDate} + (\text{ReschedDate} - \text{EffDueDate})$. Production phasing is preserved.

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